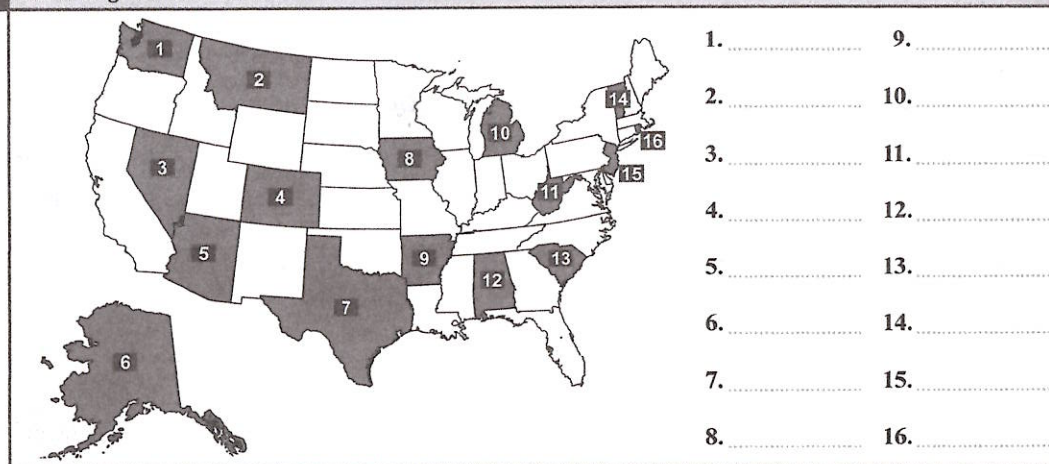


9 BASIC FACTS ABOUT THE USA

3 Combine locations with characteristics.

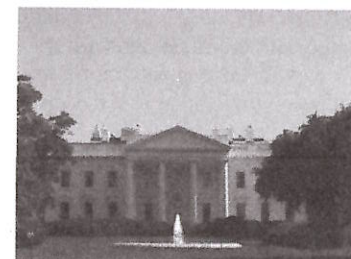
1. Los Angeles	a) Independence Hall	1
2. San Francisco	b) casinos	2
3. Boston	c) jazz	3
4. Pennsylvania Dutch Country	d) Hollywood	4
5. Philadelphia	e) Amish people	5
6. Great Lakes	f) Harvard University	6
7. Florida	g) Niagara Falls	7
8. New Orleans	h) "winter holiday state"	8
9. Memphis	i) Mount Rushmore	9
10. Phoenix	j) Elvis Presley	10
11. Black Hills	k) booming desert metropolis	11
12. Las Vegas	l) Alcatraz	12

4 Label all green-marked states.



WASHINGTON D.C.

- The capital of the USA
- Lies in the southeast of the USA on the river Potomac between Maryland and Virginia. It is the only city that is not a part of a state
- It covers the entire area of the District of Columbia (D.C.) and it is under the jurisdiction of the federal government
- Serves as the seat of the federal government, the President, the Congress and the Supreme Court
- President George Washington chose the site of the city in 1791, and Washington replaced Philadelphia as the nation's capital in 1800. The city was named in honour of George Washington
- It is divided into four sections: Northwest, Northeast, Southwest, and Southeast. Each section is named for its direction from the Capitol
- Most main government buildings, monuments and museums stand in the west-central part of the city:
 - The White House has served as the home of every U.S. president except G. Washington. It has 132 rooms, some of which are open to the public
 - The United States Capitol is the place where the U.S. Congress makes the nation's laws
 - The Lincoln Memorial; the Supreme Court building that resembles a Greek temple; the Jefferson Memorial; the Washington Monument; the Marine Corps War Memorial; the Library of Congress that includes about 98 million items; Ford's Theatre, the playhouse where A. Lincoln was shot



North side of the White House



The United States Capitol

NEW YORK CITY

- The largest city in the USA
- Since its founding by Dutch settlers in 1626, who purchased Manhattan (the then New Amsterdam) from Native Americans for 24 USD, New York has attracted immigrants from the whole world
- It lies on the Hudson River, in the southeast corner of New York State
- The city is divided into five areas called boroughs: Manhattan, the Bronx, Queens, Brooklyn and Staten Island
- Manhattan is the oldest and most important borough. It has the city's tallest buildings, some of the world's most exclusive shops, the nation's largest schools and colleges, a famous financial centre (the Wall Street) and a theatrical district (SoHo, Greenwich Village). Broadway runs across the northern part of Manhattan and is one of NYC's largest and best-known streets. Manhattan is laid out in a regular pattern of perpendicular streets. Avenues run north to south and numbered streets run east to west. Central Park separates the Upper East Side which is considered the most fashionable area, and the Upper West Side which is the middle class area. Harlem is considered a traditional centre of business and cultural activities of NYC's black population; the area consists of tenement houses
- Brooklyn is an important port and industrial centre
- The Bronx is mainly a residential area
- Queens is an industrial area with famous landmarks such as Long Island, Flushing Meadow, Central Park and the J.F.K. International Airport
- Staten Island is the smallest borough with some less-than-developed localities
- Places to visit: the Guggenheim Museum (circular building designed by the famous American architect Frank Lloyd Wright in 1937), the Statue of Liberty (considered a symbol of freedom; it stands on Liberty Island; given to the USA by France in 1884), the Empire State Building (a 381 metre high skyscraper), Saint Patrick's Cathedral (the seat of the Roman Catholic Archdiocese of NY), skyscrapers in Manhattan



New York's skyline



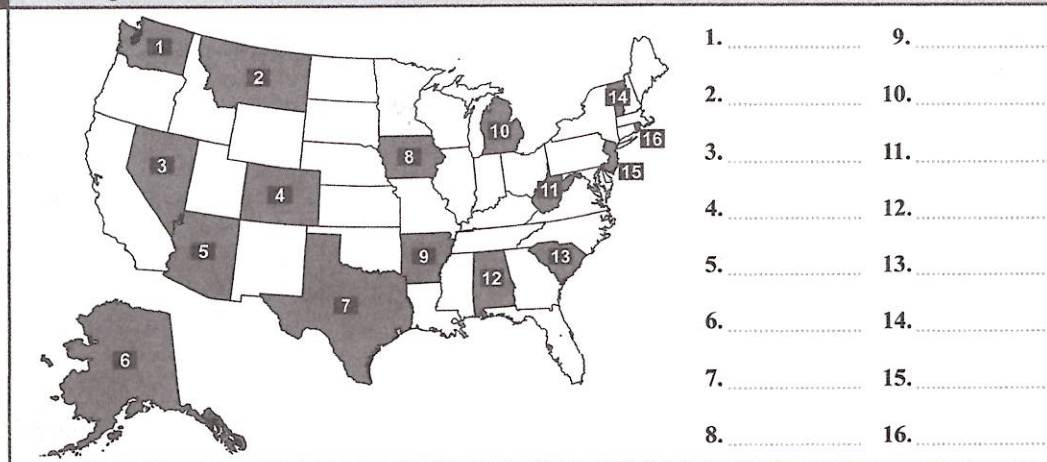
Statue of Liberty and Liberty Island

9 BASIC FACTS ABOUT THE USA

3 Combine locations with characteristics.

1. Los Angeles	a) Independence Hall	1
2. San Francisco	b) casinos	2
3. Boston	c) jazz	3
4. Pennsylvania Dutch Country	d) Hollywood	4
5. Philadelphia	e) Amish people	5
6. Great Lakes	f) Harvard University	6
7. Florida	g) Niagara Falls	7
8. New Orleans	h) "winter holiday state"	8
9. Memphis	i) Mount Rushmore	9
10. Phoenix	j) Elvis Presley	10
11. Black Hills	k) booming desert metropolis	11
12. Las Vegas	l) Alcatraz	12

4 Label all green-marked states.



WASHINGTON D.C.

- The capital of the USA
- Lies in the southeast of the USA on the river Potomac between Maryland and Virginia. It is the only city that is not a part of a state
- It covers the entire area of the District of Columbia (D.C.) and it is under the jurisdiction of the federal government
- Serves as the seat of the federal government, the President, the Congress and the Supreme Court
- President George Washington chose the site of the city in 1791, and Washington replaced Philadelphia as the nation's capital in 1800. The city was named in honour of George Washington
- It is divided into four sections: Northwest, Northeast, Southwest, and Southeast. Each section is named for its direction from the Capitol
- Most main government buildings, monuments and museums stand in the west-central part of the city:
 - The White House has served as the home of every U.S. president except G. Washington. It has 132 rooms, some of which are open to the public
 - The United States Capitol is the place where the U.S. Congress makes the nation's laws
 - The Lincoln Memorial; the Supreme Court building that resembles a Greek temple; the Jefferson Memorial; the Washington Monument; the Marine Corps War Memorial; the Library of Congress that includes about 98 million items; Ford's Theatre, the playhouse where A. Lincoln was shot



North side of the White House



The United States Capitol

NEW YORK CITY

- The largest city in the USA
- Since its founding by Dutch settlers in 1626, who purchased Manhattan (the then New Amsterdam) from Native Americans for 24 USD, New York has attracted immigrants from the whole world
- It lies on the Hudson River, in the southeast corner of New York State
- The city is divided into five areas called boroughs: Manhattan, the Bronx, Queens, Brooklyn and Staten Island
- Manhattan is the oldest and most important borough. It has the city's tallest buildings, some of the world's most exclusive shops, the nation's largest schools and colleges, a famous financial centre (the Wall Street) and a theatrical district (SoHo, Greenwich Village). Broadway runs across the northern part of Manhattan and is one of NYC's largest and best-known streets. Manhattan is laid out in a regular pattern of perpendicular streets. Avenues run north to south and numbered streets run east to west. Central Park separates the Upper East Side which is considered the most fashionable area, and the Upper West Side which is the middle class area. Harlem is considered a traditional centre of business and cultural activities of NYC's black population; the area consists of tenement houses
- Brooklyn is an important port and industrial centre
- The Bronx is mainly a residential area
- Queens is an industrial area with famous landmarks such as Long Island, Flushing Meadow, Central Park and the J.F.K. International Airport
- Staten Island is the smallest borough with some less-than-developed localities
- Places to visit: the Guggenheim Museum (circular building designed by the famous American architect Frank Lloyd Wright in 1937), the Statue of Liberty (considered a symbol of freedom; it stands on Liberty Island; given to the USA by France in 1884), the Empire State Building (a 381 metre high skyscraper), Saint Patrick's Cathedral (the seat of the Roman Catholic Archdiocese of NY), skyscrapers in Manhattan



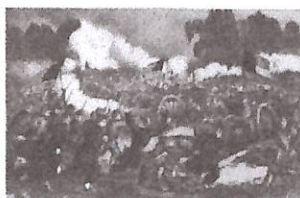
New York's skyline



Statue of Liberty and Liberty Island

HISTORY OF THE USA

- Christopher Columbus sailing under the Spanish flag discovered America in
- The English founded the first permanent settlement in the New World in (town), (state).
- The from the ship established a settlement at Plymouth in
- Pennsylvania was settled by a religious group led by W. Penn, commonly called
- After the decisive war between France and England, which ended with the Treaty of Paris in, England became the supreme power in America.
- (1773) was the first conflict in a chain of events leading to the War of Independence with Britain.
- The Declaration of Independence, created mainly by Thomas, was adopted in
-, the first US president, was inaugurated in 1789.
- In 1791 was ratified and its first ten Amendments were added to the Constitution.
- In 1800 the national capital was moved from to
- The historic (name of the period) started after the conquest of California in 1849. It is described often in 's (American writer) books.
- In (year) the War started after the Confederate batteries at Charleston fired on the Union-held Fort Sumter.
- In 1863 (document) took effect and slavery was abolished.
- In 1865 General surrendered to General Grant. The war ended in the surrender at Appomattox and Lincoln was (killed) five days later at Ford's Theatre in Washington D.C., by the Southern fanatic (name).
- The era of expansion and reform (1877–1914) was characterized by great inventions. Name 3–4 of them.
 -
 -
 -
 -
- WWI broke out in Europe in 1914. The USA declared war on Germany in was the president of the USA at that time.
- The stock market crashed in 1929 and the era called began.
- In 1932 was elected president. His political programme was called the New Deal.
- The Japanese attacked (place) in Afterwards the USA entered WWII.
- Explain:
 - D-day a)
 - VE-day b)
 - V-J-day c)

**THE FLAG OF THE UNITED STATES**

The basic flag of the United States is one of the world's oldest national flags. Only the basic flags of Austria, Denmark, Great Britain, the Netherlands, Sweden and Switzerland are 1)

During the discovery and settlement of what is now the United States, the flags of various European nations were flown over the land as symbols of possession. The first official flag of the United States was created by Congress on June 14, 2) It consisted of 13 alternate red and white stripes and 13 white stars in a field of blue, representing the 13 colonies that had declared their independence in 1776.

The evolution of the stars and stripes reflects the growth of the United States. After the admission of Hawaii into the Union in 3) the flag was officially changed for the twenty-sixth time since its creation – 50 stars and 13 stripes.

FLAG TRADITIONS

Many traditions have grown up regarding the display and use of the United States flag. These traditions intended as marks of respect are widely observed. Here are just some of the rules included in the 4)

- The flag should be flown only from sunrise to sunset. Upon special occasions, however, it may be displayed at night to produce a patriotic effect



- The flag should be displayed during school days in or near every schoolhouse
- When used to cover a coffin the flag should be placed so that the union is at the head and over the left shoulder. The flag should not be lowered into the grave or be allowed to touch the 5) The coffin should be carried foot first

SALUTE TO THE FLAG

When the flag is passing in a parade or review, or is being hoisted or lowered, all persons should face the flag, stand at attention and salute. Those in uniform should render the military salute. Men not in uniform should remove the hat with the right hand and hold the hat at the left shoulder, the hand being over the 6) Men without hats and women should place the right hand over the heart. Non-US citizens should stand at attention. Viewers should salute the flag in a parade as it passes them.

When the national 7) is played and the flag is not displayed, all present should stand and face toward the music. Those in uniform should salute at the first note and retain this position until the last note. All others should stand at attention, the men removing their hats. When the flag is displayed all should face it and give the appropriate salute.

**1 Fill in the missing geographical details.****UNITED STATES – FACTS AND FIGURES**

Official name
 Capital
 Area
 Borders
 The highest mountain
 The largest canyon
 The lowest valley
 Rivers, lakes
PEOPLE
 Population
 Largest cities
 Ethnic groups

GOVERNMENT

Form of government
 Head of state
 Head of government
 Highest court
 First-level political divisions

ECONOMY

Agriculture
 Mining
 Manufacturing
 Currency
 Major exports
 Major imports

"And so, my fellow Americans: ask not what your country can do for you – ask what you can do for your country. My fellow citizens of the world: ask not what America will do for you, but what together we can do for the freedom of man."

John Fitzgerald Kennedy (1917–1963), president of the USA

"It isn't the oceans which cut us off from the rest of the world – it's the American way of looking at things."

Henry Miller (1891–1980), American novelist



1 READ ABOUT IT

Read the basic facts about the geography of the USA and summarize it using important missing vocabulary. Focus on verbs.

BASIC FACTS

Capital: Washington D.C.

Official name: The United States of America

Largest cities: New York, Los Angeles, Chicago, Philadelphia, San Francisco, Houston, Detroit...

Metropolitan areas: New York – Boston, Metro Atlanta, Baltimore – Washington D.C.

Symbols of the USA: Include the American flag and the Great Seal. The eagle holds an olive branch and arrows, symbolizing a desire for peace but the ability to wage war. The reverse side bears the Eye of Providence representing God and a pyramid dated 1776.

LAND AND CLIMATE:

Land: In North America (area 9,372,571 sq km)

Includes Alaska and Hawaii. Borders on Canada and Mexico, the Pacific and Atlantic Oceans. Several high mountain ranges in the western part of the country, including the Rockies, the Sierra Nevada and the Cascade Range. Coastal plain and the Appalachian Mountains in the east. Central area mostly plains. Five Great Lakes in the northeast, four of them shared with Canada. The Mississippi-Missouri-Ohio river system drains the great central plains. Major rivers include the Columbia River in the northwest, the Sacramento River in California, the Colorado River in the southwest, the Rio Grande in the south-central area and many others that flow from the Appalachians to the Atlantic Ocean.

Elevation: • highest 6,194m Mount McKinley in Alaska

• lowest 86m below sea level in Death Valley in California

Climate: The Pacific Ocean moderates the temperatures on the West Coast; mild summers, cool winters. Inland southwest desert and semi-desert, very hot in summer. Weather patterns in the southeast and south-central areas are similar to the northeast and north-central areas, but warmer. Alaska is arctic, Hawaii is tropical (hurricanes, earthquakes, fires are typical).

GOVERNMENT:

Form of government: Federal republic

Head of state: President (elected by the people for a 4-year term)

Legislature: Congress consists of two houses: the 100-member Senate, elected for a term of 6 years; the 435-member House of Representatives, elected for a term of 2 years. The Constitution (since 1790) establishes the basic form of government: three separate branches, each one with power over the others.

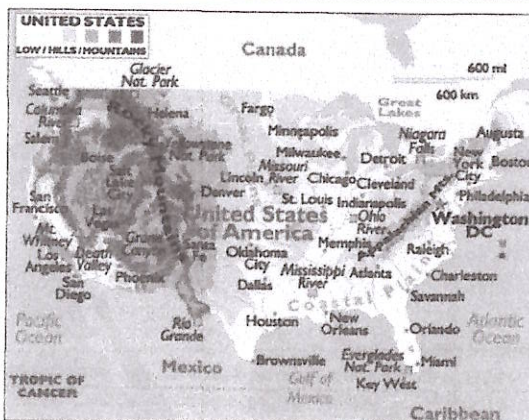
The three branches are: executive (President), legislative (Congress) and judicial (Supreme Court).

Subdivisions: 50 states with local subdivisions

PEOPLE

Population: 293 million (as of the 2004 census)

Major ethnic/national groups: Caucasian (white), African American, Hispanic, Asian, Native American



Badwater, Death Valley

Important products: agriculture – beef cattle, soybeans; manufacturing – tools and beverages, cars, airplanes; communication equipment; mining – petroleum, natural gas, coal

Currency: US dollar = 100 cents

Major exported goods: cars, computers, airplanes, scientific measuring instruments

Major imported goods: petroleum, cars, clothing, telecommunication equipment

REGIONS

The country can be divided into regions: New England, the Middle Atlantic, the South, the Midwest, the Southwest and the Northwest, or West. Each part of the country has its own habits, culinary specialities, ways of speaking the English language and outlooks on life.

New England consist of six states – Maine, Vermont, New Hampshire, Massachusetts, Connecticut and Rhode Island – along the Atlantic Ocean, including parts of New York.

Highlights: • Boston – a cultural, educational and commercial centre (Harvard University, MIT in nearby Cambridge);
• Vermont – a state with typical rural settlements and farms

The Middle Atlantic Region consists of seven states: New York, Pennsylvania, New Jersey, Delaware, Maryland, Virginia and West Virginia. The Great Valley extends through the Appalachians; it is one of the longest valleys in the world.

Highlights: • New York City – the largest city in the United States
• Niagara Falls – 50 metres high and more than a kilometre wide
• Pennsylvania Dutch Country – a farming region settled by Germans and Swiss in 1600s, their descendants are today's Amish people
• Philadelphia – a major city; Independence Hall where the Declaration of Independence was signed



Niagara Falls

The South consists of eleven states – Tennessee, Alabama, Mississippi, Arkansas, Texas, Oklahoma, Louisiana and others – along the Gulf Coast. The most important crop is cotton and tobacco. The Great Smoky National Park.

Highlights: • Washington D.C. – the capital of the USA, the headquarters of the federal government, the President, Congress and the Supreme Court
• Atlanta – a cultural and financial centre
• Florida – the "winter holiday state", Miami is a famous resort and a commercial centre
• New Orleans – a city with a typical French atmosphere; famous for jazz

The Midwest consists of thirteen states: Iowa, Missouri, Illinois, Indiana, Kentucky, West Virginia and others. Black Hills, the Great Lakes (Superior, Michigan, Huron, Erie, Ontario). Three agricultural belts according to most valuable crops: corn belt, wheat belt, dairy belt.

Highlights: • Chicago – the third largest city in the country; the Sears Tower
• Detroit – a city famous for car production; Henry Ford Museum
• Minneapolis – a city with "skyways", passageways between buildings above street level
• The North Woods – evergreen coniferous forests; abundant wildlife

The North West Region is sometimes divided into the Rocky Mountain States (Idaho, Montana, Wyoming, Colorado, Utah, and New Mexico) and the Pacific Northwest (Oregon, Washington, Alaska).

Highlights: • Yellowstone National Park (established in 1872), Glacier National Park, Yosemite National Park
• Denver, Seattle, the Colorado Rockies – the ski resorts of Vail and Aspen
• Salt Lake City – Mormons
• Alaska – its largest city Anchorage; Inuits (native population)

The Southwest and Hawaii consists of California, Arizona and Nevada. The Sequoia National Park, the Great Basin with the Death Valley. A lot of Spanish and Mexican people live here. Some Native Americans live in reservations, e.g. the Navajo and Shoshone people.

Highlights: • San Francisco – a city famous for cable cars; Chinatown, The Golden Gate, Alcatraz
• Los Angeles – a famous city of the film industry; Hollywood, Beverly Hills, Pasadena, Long Beach
• The Grand Canyon – 30 km wide and 1.6 km deep; the canyon walls record 2 billion years of the Earth's geological history
• Las Vegas – a city of casinos, slot machines and gaming tables



Colorado River in the Grand Ca